8 Programming

In this chapter, you will learn about:

- ★ programming concepts:
  - use of variables and constants
  - input and output
  - sequence
  - selection including nesting
  - iteration
  - totalling and counting
  - string handling
  - operators – arithmetic, logical and Boolean
  - procedures and functions including the use of:
    - parameters
    - local and global variables
  - library routines
  - creating a maintainable program
- ★ arrays: including one- and two-dimensional arrays, use of indexes, use of iteration for reading from and writing to arrays
- ★ file handling: including opening, closing, reading from and writing to data and text files.



The previous chapter enabled you to develop your computational thinking by writing algorithms to perform various tasks. This chapter will show you how to put your computational thinking to the ultimate test by writing computer programs to perform tasks.

So far you have tested your algorithms by dry-running. Once you have written a program for your algorithm, and when there are no syntax errors (see Chapter 4), you will now use a computer to run the program to complete the task you have specified. The computer will perform the task exactly as you have written it; you may need to make some changes before it works exactly as you intend it to.

In Chapter 4 you learned that programs could be written in high- or low-level languages then translated and run. This chapter will introduce you to the programming concepts required for practical use of a high-level language. This chapter shows the concepts behind such programming languages but should be used in conjunction with learning the syntax of an appropriate programming language.

There are many high-level programming languages to choose from. For IGCSE Computer Science the high-level programming languages recommended are Python, Visual Basic or Java. The use of one of these languages is also required for A Level Computer Science.

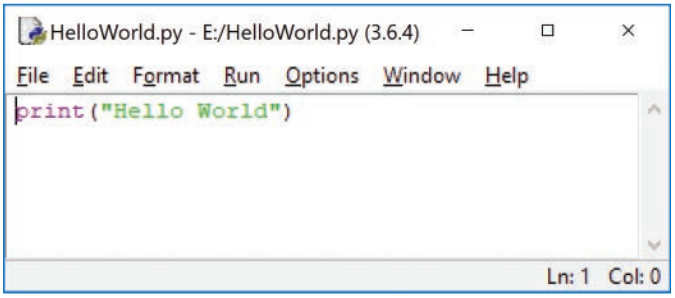
Many programming languages need an interactive development environment (IDE) to write and run code. IDEs are free to download and use.

Programs developed in this chapter will be illustrated using the following freely available languages:

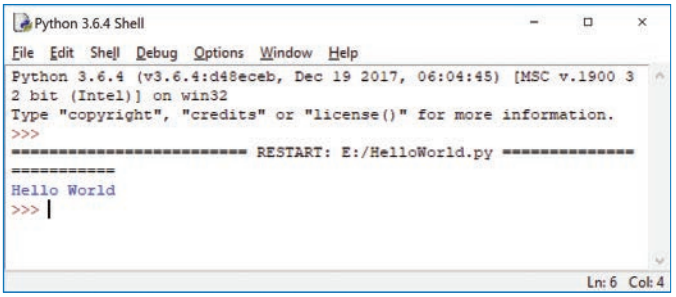
- **Python** a general purpose, open source programming language that promotes rapid program development and readable code. The IDE used for screenshots in this chapter is called **IDLE**.
- **Visual Basic**, a widely used programming language for Windows. The IDE used for screenshots in this chapter is called **Visual Studio**.
- **Java**, a commercial language used by many developers. The IDE used for screenshots in this chapter is called **BlueJ**.

The traditional introduction to programming in any language is to display the words 'Hello World' on a computer screen. The programs look very different, but the output is the same:

Python

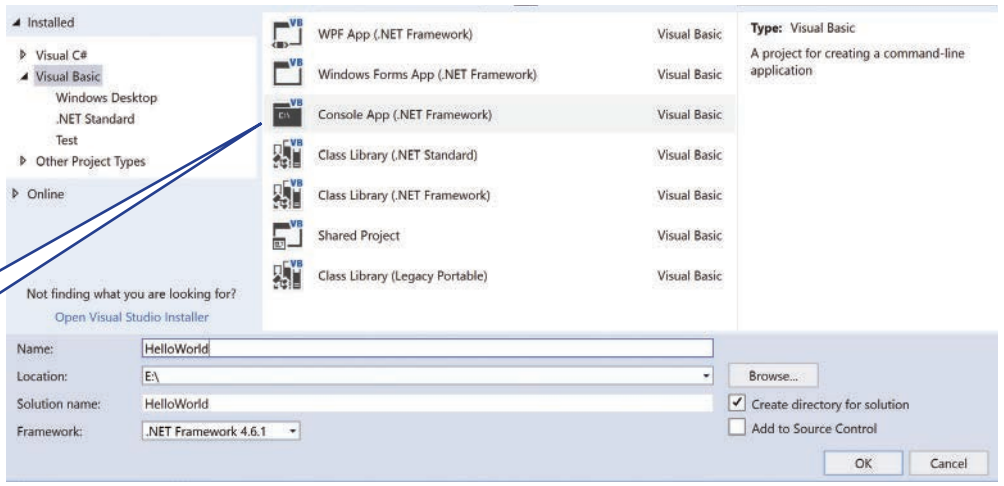


▲ **Figure 8.1** The editing window for Python



▲ **Figure 8.2** The runtime window for Python

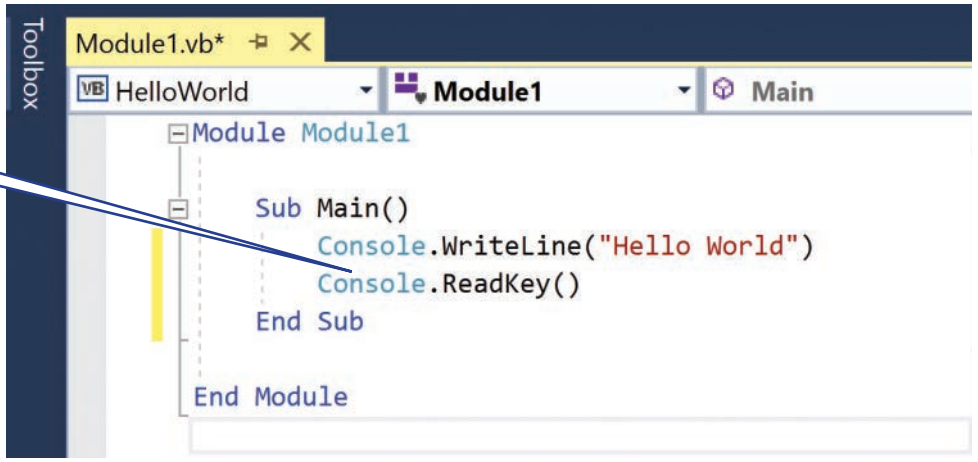
Visual Basic



Visual Basic programs are console apps for simplicity

▲ **Figure 8.3** The Visual Basic program will run in a command line window

The Console. `ReadKey()` will ensure that the output remains on screen.

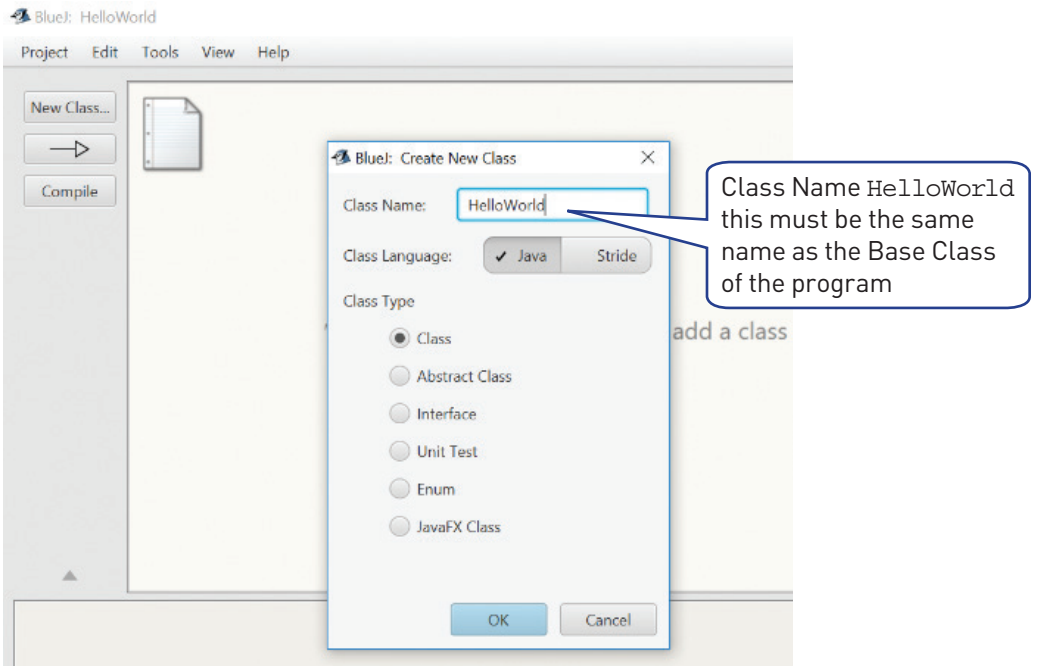


▲ **Figure 8.4** The editing window for Visual Basic



▲ **Figure 8.5** The runtime window for Visual Basic

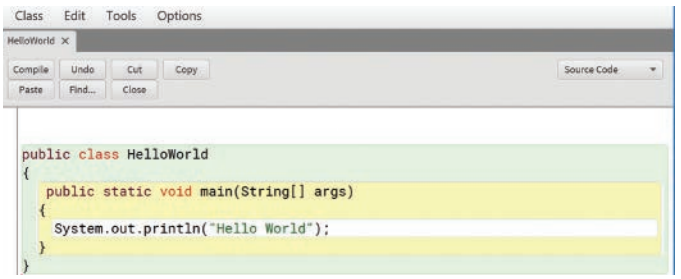
Java



▲ **Figure 8.6** Setting up the class for Java



▲ **Figure 8.7** The project window for Java



▲ **Figure 8.8** The editing window for Java



▲ **Figure 8.9** The terminal window to show the output from the program Java

Activity 8.1

Write and test the Hello World program in your chosen programming language.

Find out more

Find out more about each of the three programming languages Python, Visual Basic and Java. Decide, with the help of your teacher, which programming language will be best to use for your IGCSE work.

Programming is a skill that takes time and practice to develop. In the next sections of this chapter, after you have decided which programming language you are going to use, you can just consider the examples for your chosen language.

8.1 Programming concepts

There are five basic constructs to use and understand when developing a program:

- data use – variables, constants and arrays
- sequence – order of steps in a task
- selection – choosing a path through a program
- iteration – repetition of a sequence of steps in a program
- operator use – arithmetic for calculations, logical and Boolean for decisions.

8.1.1 Variables and constants

In a program, any data used can have a fixed value that does not change while the program is running.

A **variable** in a computer program is a named data store than contains a value that may change during the execution of a program. In order to make programs understandable to others, variables should be given meaningful names.

A **constant** in a computer program is a named data store than contains a value that does not change during the execution of a program. As with variables,

in order to make programs understandable to others, constants should also be given meaningful names.

Not all programming languages explicitly differentiate between constants and variables, but programmers should be clear which data stores can be changed and which cannot be changed. There are several ways of highlighting a constant, for example:

Use of capital letters	`PI = 3.142`
Meaningful names that begin with Const	`ConstPi = 3.142`

It is considered good practice to **declare** the constants and variables to be used in that program. Some languages require explicit declarations, which specifically state what type of data the variable or constant will hold. Other languages require implicit declarations, where the data type is based on the value assigned. Declarations can be at the start of a program or just before the data is used for the first time.

Here are some sample declaration statements in pseudocode and programming code – just look at the sections for pseudocode and the programming language you are using.

▼ **Table 8.1** How to declare variables and constants

Declarations of constants and variables	Language

`DECLARE FirstVar : INTEGER`
`DECLARE SecondVar : INTEGER`
`CONSTANT FirstConst ← 500`
`CONSTANT SecondConst ← 100`
	Pseudocode declarations, variables are explicit but constants are implicit.

`FirstVar = 20`
`SecondVar = 30`
`FIRSTCONST = 500`
`SECONDCONST = 100`
or
`FirstVar, SecondVar = 20, 30`
`FirstConst, SecondConst = 500,100`
	Python does not require any separate declarations and does not differentiate between constants and variables.
	Programmers need to keep track of and manage these differences instead.

`Dim FirstVar As Integer`
`Dim SecondVar As Integer`
`Const FirstConst As Integer = 500`
`Const SecondConst As Integer = 500`
or
`Dim FirstVar, SecondVar As Integer`
`Const First, Second As Integer = 500, 100`
	In Visual Basic variables are explicitly declared as particular data types before use. Declarations can be single statements or multiple declarations in a single statement. Constants can be explicitly typed as shown or implicitly typed, for example:
	`Const First = 500`
	... which implicitly defines the constant as an integer.

`int FirstVar;`
`int SecondVar;`
`final int FIRSTCONST = 500;`
`final int SECONDCONST = 100;`
	In Java constant values are declared as variables with a final value so no changes can be made. These final variable names are usually capitalised to show they cannot be changed.
	Variables are often declared as they are used rather than at the start of the code.

8.1.2 Basic data types

In order for a computer system to process and store data effectively, different kinds of data are formally given different types. This enables:

- data to be stored in an appropriate way, for example, as numbers or as characters
- data to be manipulated effectively, for example, numbers with mathematical operators and characters with concatenation
- automatic validation in some cases.

The basic data types you will need to use for IGCSE Computer Science are:

- integer – a positive or negative whole number that can be used with mathematical operators
- real – a positive or negative number with a fractional part. Real numbers can be used with mathematical operators
- char – a variable or constant that is a single character
- string – a variable or constant that is several characters in length. Strings vary in length and may even have no characters (known as an empty string); the characters can be letters and/or digits and/or any other printable symbol (If a number is stored as a string then it cannot be used in calculations.)
- Boolean – a variable or constant that can have only two values TRUE or FALSE.

▼ **Table 8.2** Examples of data types

Pseudocode	Python	Visual Basic	Java
INTEGER	`FirstInteger = 25`	`Dim FirstInt As Integer`	`int FirstInt;` or `byte FirstInt;`
REAL	`FirstReal = 25.0`	`Dim FirstReal As Decimal`	`float FirstReal;` or `double FirstReal;`
CHAR	`Female = 'F'` or `Female = "F"`	`Dim Female As Char`	`char Female;`
STRING	`FirstName = 'Emma'` or `FirstName = "Emma"`	`Dim FirstName As String`	`String FirstName;`
BOOLEAN	`Flag = True`	`Dim Flag As Boolean`	`boolean Flag;`

Activity 8.2

In pseudocode and the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use, declare the variables and constants you would use in an algorithm to find the volume of a cylinder.

8.1.3 Input and output

In order to be able to enter data and output results, programs need to use input and output statements. For IGCSE Computer Science you need to be able to write algorithms and programs that take input from a keyboard and output to a screen.

For a program to be useful, the user needs to know what they are expected to input, so each input needs to be accompanied by a **prompt** stating the input required.

Here are examples of inputs in programming code – pseudocode was considered in Chapter 7. Just look at the section for the programming language you are using.

In a programming language the data type of the input must match the required data type of the variable where the input data is to be stored. All inputs default as strings, so if the input should be an integer or real number, commands are also used to change the data type of the input (for instance, in Python these are `int()` or `float()`).

Table 8.3 Examples of input statements with prompts

Input statements	Language
`radius = float(input("Please enter the radius of the cylinder "))`	Python combines the prompt with the input statement.
`Console.Write("Please enter the radius of the cylinder ")` `radius = Decimal.Parse(Console.ReadLine())`	Visual Basic uses a separate prompt and input. The input specifies the type of data expected.

`import java.util.Scanner;`
`Scanner myObj = new Scanner(System.in);`
`System.out.println("Please enter the radius of the cylinder ");`
`double radius = myObj.nextDouble();`
	In Java the input library has to be imported at the start of the program and an input object is set up. Java uses a separate prompt and input. The input specifies the type and declares the variable of the same type.

Find out more

These input statements use a programming technique called casting, which converts variables from one data type to another. Find out more about the use of casting in the programming language that you have decided to use.

Activity 8.2a

In the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use, write expressions that would store user inputs as the data types represented by the following:

- 12
- 12.00
- X
- X marks the spot
- TRUE.

For a program to be useful, the user needs to know what results are being output, so each output needs to be accompanied by a **message** explaining the result. If there are several parts to an output statement, then each part is separated by a separator character.

Here are examples of outputs in programming code – pseudocode was considered in Chapter 7. Just look at the section for the programming language you are using.

Table 8.4 Examples of output statements with messages

Output the results	Language
`print("Volume of the cylinder is ", volume)`	Python uses a comma
`Console.WriteLine("Volume of the cylinder is " & volume)`	VB uses &
`System.out.println("Volume of the cylinder is " + volume);`	Java uses +

Activity 8.3

In the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use, write and run your own program that calculates and displays the volume of a cylinder.

Examples of the complete programs are shown below:

Python

```
CONSTPI = 3.142
Radius = float(input("Please enter the radius of the cylinder "))
Length = float(input("Please enter the length of the cylinder "))
Volume = Radius * Radius * Length * CONSTPI
print("Volume of the cylinder is ", Volume)
```

Visual Basic

Every console program in VB must contain a Main module. These statements are shown in red.

```
Module Module1
    Public Sub Main()
        Dim Radius As Decimal
        Dim Length As Decimal
        Dim Volume As Decimal
        Const PI As Decimal = 3.142
        Console.Write("Please enter the radius of the cylinder ")
        Radius = Decimal.Parse(Console.ReadLine())
        Console.Write("Please enter the length of the cylinder ")
        Length = Decimal.Parse(Console.ReadLine())
        Volume = Radius * Radius * Length * PI
        Console.WriteLine("Volume of cylinder is " & volume)
        Console.ReadKey()
    End Sub
End Module
```

Java

Every console program in Java must contain a class with the file name and a main procedure. These statements are shown in red.

Every statement in Java must have a semi-colon ; at the end.

```
import java.util.Scanner;
class Cylinder
{
    public static void main(String args[])
     {
          Scanner myObj = new Scanner(System.in);
          final double PI = 3.142;
          double Radius;
          double Length;
          System.out.println("Please enter the radius of the
          cylinder ");
          Radius = myObj.nextDouble();
          System.out.println("Please enter the length of the
          sphere ");
          Length = myObj.nextDouble();
          double Volume = Radius * Radius * Length * PI;
       System.out.println("Volume of cylinder is " + volume);
       }
}
```

8.1.4 Basic concepts

When writing the steps required to solve a problem, the following concepts need to be used and understood:

- sequence
- selection
- iteration
- counting and totalling
- string handling
- use of operators.

8.1.4(a) Sequence

The ordering of the steps in an algorithm is very important. An incorrect order can lead to incorrect results and/or extra steps that are not required by the task.

Link

For more on **REPEAT...UNTIL** loops in pseudocode see Section 7.2.3.

Worked example

For example, the following pseudocode algorithm uses a **REPEAT...UNTIL** loop to calculate and output total marks, average marks and the number of marks entered.

```
DECLARE, Total, Average : REAL
DECLARE Mark, Counter : INTEGER
Total ← 0
Mark ← 0
Counter ← 0
OUTPUT "Enter marks, 999 to finish "
REPEAT
  INPUT Mark
  Total ← Total + Mark
  IF Mark = 999
    THEN
      Average ← Total / Counter
  ENDIF
  Counter ← Counter + 1
UNTIL Mark = 999
OUTPUT "The total mark is ", Total
OUTPUT "The average mark is ", Average
OUTPUT "The number of marks is ", Counter
```

A trace table is completed using this test data:

25, 27, 23, 999

Table 8.5 Trace table of dry run for algorithm with an incorrect sequence

Total	Average	Counter	Mark	OUTPUT
0	0	0		Enter marks, 999 to finish
25		1	25	
52		2	27	
75		3	23	
1074	358	4	999	
				The total mark is 1074
				The average mark is 358
				The number of marks is 4

As you can see all the outputs are incorrect.

However if the order of the steps is changed, and the unnecessary test removed, the algorithm now works.

```
DECLARE, Total, Average : REAL
DECLARE Mark, Counter : INTEGER
Total ← 0
Mark ← 0
Counter ← -1
OUTPUT "Enter marks, 999 to finish "
REPEAT
  Total ← Total + Mark
  INPUT Mark
  Counter ← Counter + 1
UNTIL Mark = 999
OUTPUT "The total mark is ", Total
Average ← Total / Counter
OUTPUT "The average mark is ", Average
OUTPUT "The number of marks is ", Counter
```

Counter starts at –1 to allow the extra mark of 999 not to be counted.

Average now calculated outside the loop. No need to test if the last input.

A trace table is completed using the same test data:

25, 27, 23, 999

▼ **Table 8.6** Trace table of dry run for algorithm with a correct sequence

Total	Average	Counter	Mark	OUTPUT
0	0	–1		Enter marks, 999 to finish
25		0	25	
52		1	27	
75		2	23	
		3	999	
				The total mark is 75
	25			The average mark is 25
				The number of marks is 3

As you can see all the outputs are now correct.

Find out more

Write and test a program, in the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use, including similar steps to the corrected pseudocode algorithm.

8.1.4(b) Selection

Selection is a very useful technique, allowing different routes through the steps of a program. For example, data items can be picked out according to given criteria, such as: selecting the largest value or smallest value, selecting items over a certain price, selecting everyone who is male.

Selection was demonstrated in pseudocode with the use of **IF** and **CASE** statements in Chapter 7.

Find out more

Using the high-level programming language that your school has chosen, find out about the structure of **IF…THEN…ELSE** and **CASE** statements. Not all programming languages include the use of a **CASE** statement.

IF statements

Look at some of the different types of **IF** statements available in your programming language.

▼ **Table 8.7** IF statements single choice

IF statement single choice example	Language

`IF Age > 17`
`  THEN`
`  OUTPUT "You are an adult"`
`ENDIF`
	Pseudocode

`if Age > 17:` `  print ("You are an adult")`	Python does not use **THEN** or **ENDIF** just a colon : and indentation

`If Age > 17 Then`
`  Console.WriteLine("You are an adult")`
`End If`
	Visual Basic uses **Then** and **End If**

`If (Age > 17) {`
`  System.out.println ("You are an adult");`
`}`
	Java uses curly brackets, {, instead of **THEN** and uses } instead of **ENDIF**.

▼ **Table 8.8** IF statements single choice with alternative

IF statement single choice with alternative example	Language

`IF Age > 17`
`  THEN`
`  OUTPUT "You are an adult"`
`  ELSE`
`  OUTPUT "You are a child"`
`ENDIF`
	Pseudocode

▼ **Table 8.8** (*Continued*)

`if Age > 17:`
`  print ("You are an adult")`
`else:`
`  print ("You are a child")`
	Python uses else with a colon, **:** and indentation.

`If Age > 17 Then`
`  Console.WriteLine("You are an adult")`
`Else`
`  Console.WriteLine("You are a child")`
`End If`
	Visual Basic uses **Else** and **End If**

`If (Age > 17) {`
`  System.out.println ("You are an adult");`
`} else {`
`  System.out.println ("You are a child");`
`}`
	Java uses **else** and curly brackets, {, and uses } instead of **ENDIF**.

Activity 8.4

In the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use, write and run a short program to test if a number input is greater than or equal to 100 or less than 100.

Case statements

Case statements are used when there are multiple choices to be made. Different programming languages provide different types of statement to do this. Have a look at the method your programming language uses.

▼ **Table 8.9** CASE statements multiple choice

Case statement examples	Language

`CASE OF OpValue`
`  "+" : Answer ← Number1 + Number2`
`  "-" : Answer ← Number1 - Number2`
`  "*" : Answer ← Number1 * Number2`
`  "/" : Answer ← Number1 / Number2`
`  OTHERWISE OUTPUT "Please enter a valid choice"`
`ENDCASE`
	Pseudocode

`if OpValue == "+":`
`  Answer = Number1 + Number2`
`elif OpValue == "-":`
`  Answer = Number1 - Number2`
`elif OpValue == "*":`
`  Answer = Number1 * Number2`
`elif OpValue == "/":`
`  Answer = Number1 - Number2`
`else: print("invalid operator")`
	Python uses **elif** for multiple tests

▼ **Table 8.9** (*Continued*)

`Select Case OpValue`
`  Case "+"`
`  Answer = Number1 + Number2`
`  Case "-"`
`  Answer = Number1 - Number2`
`  Case "*"`
`  Answer = Number1 * Number2`
`  Case "/"`
`  Answer = Number1 / Number2`
`  Case Else`
`  Console.WriteLine("invalid operator")`
`  End Select`
	Visual Basic uses **Select Case** and **Case Else** instead of **CASE** and **OTHERWISE**

`switch (OpValue) {`
`  case "+":`
`  Answer = Number1 + Number2;`
`  break;`
`  case "-":`
`  Answer = Number1 - Number2;`
`  break;`
`  case "*":`
`  Answer = Number1 * Number2;`
`  break;`
`  case "/":`
`  Answer = Number1 / Number2;`
`  break;`
`  default:`
`  System.out.println("invalid operator");`
`}`
	Java uses **default** instead of **OTHERWISE** and uses **break** to pass control to the end of the code block when a section is finished.

Activity 8.5

In the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use, write and run a short program to input a number and check if that number is equal to 1, 2, 3 or 4 using the **CASE** construct (or alternative where appropriate).

8.1.4(c) Iteration

As stated in Chapter 7, there are three types of loop structures available to perform iterations so that a section of programming code can be repeated under certain conditions.

These are:

- Count-controlled loops (for a set number of iterations)
- Pre-condition loops – may have no iterations
- Post-condition loops – always has at least one iteration.

Find out more

Find out about the loop structures available in the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use.

Count-controlled loops

FOR loops are used when a set number of iterations are required. Look at some of the different types of **FOR** statements with a counter starting at one, finishing at ten and increments by two for every iteration.

▼ **Table 8.10** FOR loops

For statement examples	Language
`for Counter in range (1,11,2):` `  print(Counter)`	Python uses the **range** function, a colon to show the start of the **for** loop and indentation of all statements in the **for** loop.

`For Counter = 1 To 10 Step 2`
`  Console.WriteLine(Counter)`
`Next`
	Visual Basic uses **Step** and **Next**

`for (int Counter = 1; Counter <= 10; Counter = Counter + 2)`
`{`
`  System.out.println(Counter);`
`}`
	Java uses {} to show the start and end of the **for** loop.

Condition-controlled loops

When the number of iterations is not known, there are two options:

- pre-condition loops which may have no iterations
- post-condition loops which always have at least one iteration.

Look at some of the different pre- and post-condition loops used in your programming language.

▼ **Table 8.11** Pre-condition loops

Pre-condition loops	Language
`while TotalWeight < 100:` `  TotalWeight = TotalWeight + Weight`	Python uses a colon to show the start of the **while** loop and indentation to show which statements are in the **while** loop.

`While TotalWeight < 100`
`  TotalWeight = TotalWeight + Weight`
`End While`
	Visual Basic uses **While** and **End While**

`while (TotalWeight < 100)`
`{`
`  TotalWeight = TotalWeight + Weight;`
`}`
	Java uses {} to show the start and end of the **while** loop.

▼ **Table 8.12** Post-condition loops

Post-condition loops	Language
	Python only uses pre-condition loops.

`Do`
`  NumberOfItems = NumberOfItems + 1`
`Loop Until NumberOfItems > 19`
	Visual Basic uses `Do` and `Loop Until`

`Do`
`{`
`  NumberOfItems ++;`
`}`
`while (NumberOfItems <= 20);`
	Java uses `do` and `while` so the condition is the opposite of the `until` condition used in Visual Basic. Look at the code carefully to see the difference. Java uses {} to show the start and end of the loop.

Activity 8.6

In the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use, write and run two short programs, one using a count-controlled loop and the other a condition-controlled loop. They should each repeat ten times, incrementing the loop counter by three and outputting the value for each iteration.

8.1.4(d) Totalling and counting

Totalling and **counting** were introduced in Chapter 7 as standard methods. Take a look at how these methods are implemented in your programming language.

Totalling is very similar in all three languages.

▼ **Table 8.13** Totalling

Totalling	Language
`TotalWeight = TotalWeight + Weight`	Python
`TotalWeight = TotalWeight + Weight`	Visual Basic
`TotalWeight = TotalWeight + Weight;`	Java

Counting is also similar in Python and Visual Basic, but Java uses a different type of statement.

▼ **Table 8.14** Counting

Counting	Language
`NumberOfItems = NumberOfItems + 1` `NumberOfItems +=1`	Python
`NumberOfItems = NumberOfItems + 1` `NumberOfItems +=1`	Visual Basic
`NumberOfItems ++;` `NumberOfItems = NumberOfItems + 1;`	Java

Activity 8.7

In the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use, write and run a short program using a condition-controlled loop to allow the user to input the weight of sacks of rice and to count the number of sacks the user has input. When the user types in '-1' this should stop the process and the program should then output the number of sacks entered and the total weight.

8.1.4(e) String Handling

Strings are used to store text. Every string contains a number of characters, from an empty string, which has no characters stored, to a maximum number specified by the programming language. The characters in a string can be labelled by position number. The first character in a string can be in position zero or position one, depending on the language.

Find out more

Find the maximum number of characters that the high-level programming language that your school has chosen can store in a string.

Find out the position number of the first character defined by this programming language.

String handling is an important part of programming. As an IGCSE Computer Science student, you will need to write algorithms and programs for these methods:

- **length** – finding the number of characters in the string. For example, the length of the string `"Computer Science"` is 16 characters as spaces are counted as a character.
- **substring** – extracting part of a string. For example, the substring `"Science"` could be extracted from `"Computer Science"`.
- **upper** – converting all the letters in a string to uppercase. For example, the string `"Computer Science"` would become `"COMPUTER SCIENCE"`.
- **lower** – converting all the letters in a string to lowercase. For example, the string `"Computer Science"` would become `"computer science"`.

These string manipulation methods are usually provided in programming languages by **library routines**, see later in this chapter for further use of library routines.

Most programming languages support many different string handling methods. Have a look at how your programming language would complete each of the four methods you need to be able to use.

▼ **Table 8.15** Find the length of a string

Length	Language	Notes
`LENGTH("Computer Science")` `LENGTH(MyString)`	Pseudocode	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.
`len("Computer Science")` `len(MyString)`	Python	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.
`"Computer Science".Length()` `MyString.Length()`	Visual Basic	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.
`"Computer Science".length();` `MyString.length();`	Java	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.

▼ **Table 8.16** Extracting a substring from a string

Substring – to extract the word 'Science'	Language	Notes
`SUBSTRING("Computer Science", 10, 7)` `SUBSTRING(MyString, 10, 7)`	Pseudocode	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string. First parameter is the string, second parameter is the position of the start character, third parameter is the length of the required substring. Pseudocode strings start at position one.
`"Computer Science"[9:16]` `MyString[9:16]`	Python	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string. Strings are treated as lists of characters in Python. First index is the start position of the substring. Second index is the end position of the substring. Python strings start at position zero.
`"Computer Science".Substring(9, 7)` `MyString.Substring(9, 7)`	Visual Basic	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string. First parameter is the start position of the substring, second parameter is the length of the substring. Visual Basic strings start at position zero.
`"Computer Science".substring(9,17);` `MyString.substring(9,17);`	Java	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string. First parameter is the start position of the substring, second parameter is the exclusive end position of the substring. 'Exclusive' means the position after the last character, i.e. in this example the substring is made from characters 9 to 16. Java strings start at position zero.

▼ **Table 8.17** Converting a string to upper case

Upper	Language	Notes
`UCASE("Computer Science")` `UCASE(MyString)`	Pseudocode	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.
`"Computer Science".upper()` `MyString.upper()`	Python	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.
`UCase("Computer Science")` `UCase(MyString)`	Visual Basic	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.
`"Computer Science".toUpperCase();` `MyString.toUpperCase();`	Java	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.

▼ **Table 8.18** Converting a string to lower case

Lower	Language	Notes
`LCASE("Computer Science")` `LCASE(MyString)`	Pseudocode	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.
`"Computer Science".lower()` `MyString.lower()`	Python	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.
`LCase("Computer Science")` `LCase(MyString)`	Visual Basic	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.
`"Computer Science".toLowerCase();` `MyString.toLowerCase();`	Java	Text in quotes can be used or a variable with data type string.

Find out more

Find four more string handling methods that your programming language makes use of.

Activity 8.8

In the high-level programming language that your school has chosen, write and run a short program to input your full name into a variable, **MyName**, find the length of your name, extract the first three characters of your name and display your name in upper case and in lower case.

8.1.4(f) Arithmetic, logical and Boolean operators

Arithmetic operators

All programming languages make use of arithmetic operators to perform calculations. Here are the ones you must be able to use for IGCSE Computer Science.

Advice

Expressions using operators can also be grouped together using brackets, for instance: ((x + y) * 3) / PI

▼ **Table 8.19** Mathematical operators

Operator	Action	Python	Visual Basic	Java
+	Add	+	+	+
-	Subtract	-	-	-
*	Multiply	*	*	*
/	Divide	/	/	/
^	Raise to the power of	**	^	import java.lang.Math; Math.pow(x, y)
MOD	Remainder division	For more on these see Section 8.1.7 Library routines.		
DIV	Integer division			

Activity 8.9

In the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use, write and test a short program to perform all these mathematical operations and output the results:

- Input two numbers, **Number1** and **Number2**
- Calculate **Number1 + Number2**
- Calculate **Number1 - Number2**
- Calculate **Number1 * Number2**
- Calculate **Number1 / Number2**
- Calculate **Number1 ^ Number2**
- Input an integer **Number3**
- Calculate **Number3 * (Number1 + Number2)**
- Calculate **Number3 * (Number1 - Number2)**
- Calculate **(Number1 + Number2) ^ Number3.**

Logical operators

All programming languages make use of logical operators to decide which path to take through a program. Here are the ones you must be able to use for IGCSE Computer Science.

▼ **Table 8.20** Logical operators

Operator	Comparison	Python	Visual Basic	Java
>	Greater than	>	>	>
<	Less than	<	<	<
=	Equal	==	=	==
>=	Greater than or equal	>=	>=	>=
<=	Less than or equal	<=	<=	<=
<>	Not equal	!=	<>	!=

Boolean operators

All programming languages make use of Boolean operators to decide whether an expression is true or false. Here are the ones you must be able to use for IGCSE Computer Science.

▼ **Table 8.21** Boolean operators

Operator	Description	Python	Visual Basic	Java
AND	Both True	and	And	&&
OR	Either True	or	Or	||
NOT	Not True	not	Not	!

Activity 8.10

In the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use, write and test a short program to perform all these comparisons and output the results.

- Input two numbers, **Number1** and **Number2**
- Compare **Number1** and **Number2**:
  - Output with a suitable message if both numbers are not equal
  - Output with a suitable message identifying which number is largest
  - Output with a suitable message identifying which number is smallest
  - Output with a suitable message if both numbers are equal
- Input another number **Number3**
  - Output with a suitable message if all three numbers are not equal
  - Output with a suitable message identifying which number is largest
  - Output with a suitable message identifying which number is smallest
  - Output with a suitable message if all numbers are equal.

8.1.5 Use of nested statements

Selection and iteration statements can be nested one inside the other. This powerful method reduces the amount of code that needs to be written and makes it simpler for a programmer to test their programs.

One type of construct can be nested within another – for example, selection can be nested within a condition-controlled loop, or one loop can be nested within another loop.

Worked example

For example, the following pseudocode algorithm uses nested loops to provide a solution for the problem set out here:

- calculate and output highest, lowest, and average marks awarded for a class of twenty students
- calculate and output largest, highest, lowest, and average marks awarded for each student
- calculate and output largest, highest, lowest, and average marks for each of the six subjects studied by the student; each subject has five tests.
- assume that all marks input are whole numbers between 0 and 100.

```
// Declarations of the variables needed
DECLARE ClassAverage, StudentAverage, SubjectAverage : REAL
DECLARE Student, Subject, Test : INTEGER
DECLARE ClassHigh, ClassLow, ClassTotal : INTEGER
DECLARE StudentHigh, StudentLow, StudentTotal : INTEGER
DECLARE SubjectHigh, SubjectLow, SubjectTotal : INTEGER
ClassHigh ← 0
ClassLow ← 100
ClassTotal ← 0
// Use of constants enables you to easily change the values for testing
CONSTANT NumberOfTests = 5
CONSTANT NumberOfSubjects = 6
CONSTANT ClassSize = 20
FOR Student ← 1 TO ClassSize
    StudentHigh ← 0
    StudentLow ← 100
    StudentTotal ← 0
  FOR Subject ← 1 TO NumberOfSubjects
      SubjectHigh ← 0
      SubjectLow ← 100
      SubjectTotal ← 0
    FOR Test ← 1 TO NumberOfTests
        OUTPUT "Please enter mark "
        INPUT Mark
        IF Mark > SubjectHigh
        THEN
            SubjectHigh ← Mark
        ENDIF
       IF Mark < SubjectLow
         THEN
            SubjectLow  ← Mark
```

You will need to set up these values to use in your middle loop.

You will need to set up these values to use in your inner loop.

```
        ENDIF
        SubjectTotal ← SubjectTotal + Mark
    NEXT Test
    SubjectAverage ← SubjectTotal / NumberOfTests
    OUTPUT "Average mark for Subject ", Subject, " is ", SubjectAverage
    OUTPUT "Highest mark for Subject ", Subject, " is ", SubjectHigh
    OUTPUT "Lowest mark for Subject ", Subject, " is ", SubjectLow
    IF SubjectHigh > StudentHigh
      THEN
        StudentHigh ← SubjectHigh
    ENDIF
    IF SubjectLow < StudentLow
      THEN
        StudentLow ← SubjectLow
    ENDIF
    StudentTotal ← StudentTotal + SubjectTotal
  NEXT Subject
  StudentAverage ← StudentTotal / (NumberOfTests * NumberOfSubjects
  OUTPUT "Average mark for Student ", Student, " is ", StudentAverage
  OUTPUT "Highest mark for Student ", Student, " is ", StudentHigh
  OUTPUT "Lowest mark for Student ", Student, " is ", StudentLow
  IF StudentHigh > ClassHigh
    THEN
      ClassHigh = StudentHigh
  ENDIF
 IF StudentLow < ClassLow
    THEN
      ClassLow ← StudentLow
  ENDIF
  ClassTotal ← ClassTotal + StudentTotal
NEXT Student
ClassAverage ← ClassTotal / (NumberOfTests * NumberOfSubjects * ClassSize)
OUTPUT "Average mark for Class is ", ClassAverage
OUTPUT "Highest mark for Class is ", ClassHigh
OUTPUT "Lowest mark for Class is ", ClassLow
```

You will need to use this output from your inner loop.

You will need to use these outputs from your middle loop.

Have a look at the pseudocode, start with the inner loop for the number of tests.

Activity 8.11

In the high-level programming language that your school has chosen to use, use the pseudocode solution to help you to write and test a short program to calculate and output largest, highest, lowest and average marks for a single subject with five tests taken by a student.

Hints:

- Look at the other statements and output needed as well as the loop.
- For testing purposes, you can reduce the number of tests to two or three.

Now look at the middle loop that surrounds the inner loop for the number of students.

Activity 8.12

When the single subject program is working, extend it to calculate and output largest, highest, lowest, and average marks for a single student with six subjects studied by a student.

Hints:

- Look at the other statements and outputs needed as well as the loop.
- For testing purposes reduce the number of subjects to two or three.

Finally look at the whole program that includes the outer loop for the whole class.

Activity 8.13

When the single student program is working, extend your program to complete the task to calculate and output the largest, highest, lowest, and average marks for the whole class of 20 students.

Hint:

- For testing purposes reduce the class size to two or three.

8.1.6 Procedures and functions

When writing an algorithm, there are often similar tasks to perform that make use of the same groups of statements. Instead of repeating these statements and writing new code every time they are required, many programming languages make use of subroutines, also known as named **procedures** or **functions**. These are defined once and can be called many times within a program.

Procedures, functions and parameters

A **procedure** is a set of programming statements grouped together under a single name that can be called to perform a task at any point in a program.

A **function** is a set of programming statements grouped together under a single name that can be called to perform a task at any point in a program. In contrast to a procedure, a function will return a value back to the main program.

Parameters are the variables that store the values of the arguments passed to a procedure or function. Some but not all procedures and functions will have parameters.

Definition and use of procedures and functions, with or without parameters

Procedures without parameters

Here is an example of a procedure without parameters in pseudocode:

```
PROCEDURE Stars
    OUTPUT"************"
ENDPROCEDURE
```

The procedure can then be called in the main part of the program as many times as is required in the following way:

```
CALL Stars
```

Instead of calling them procedures, different terminology is used by each programming language. Procedures are known as:

- void functions in Python
- subroutines in VB
- methods in Java.

▼ **Table 8.22** Procedure calls

Procedure Stars – definition	Call	Language
`def Stars():` `    print("************")`	`Stars()`	Python

`Sub Stars()`
`    Console.WriteLine("************")`
`End Sub`
	`Stars()`	Visual Basic

`static void Stars()`
`{`
`    System.out.println("************");`
`}`
	`Stars();`	Java

Activity 8.14

Write a short program in your chosen programming language to define and use a procedure to display three lines of stars.

It is often useful to pass a value to a procedure that can be used to modify the action(s) taken. For example, to decide how many stars would be output. This is done by passing an argument when the procedure is called to be used as a parameter by the procedure.

Procedures with parameters

Here is an example of how a procedure with parameters can be defined in pseudocode.

We can add parameters to a procedure:

```
PROCEDURE Stars (Number : INTEGER)
    DECLARE Counter : INTEGER
    FOR Counter ← 1 TO NUMBER
        OUTPUT "*"
    NEXT Counter
ENDPROCEDURE
```

Parameter with data type

Procedure with parameters are called like this – in this case to print seven stars:

```
CALL Stars (7)
```

Or:

```
MyNumber ← 7
CALL stars (MyNumber)
```

A procedure call must match the procedure definition. This means that when a procedure is defined with parameters, the arguments in the procedure call should match the parameters in the procedure definition. For IGCSE Computer Science the number of parameters used is limited to two.

▼ **Table 8.23** Procedures with parameters

Procedure stars with parameter – definition	Call	Language

`def Stars(Number):`
`  for counter in range (Number):`
`  print("*", end = "")`
	`Stars(7)`	Python
		Note: `end = ""` ensures that the stars are printed on one line without spaces between them.

`Sub Stars(Number As Integer)`
`  Dim Counter As Integer`
`  For Counter = 1 To Number`
`  Console.Write("*")`
`  Next`
`End Sub`
	`Stars(7)`	VB

`static void Stars(int Number)`
`{`
`  for (int Counter = 1; Counter <= Number; Counter ++)`
`  {`
`  System.out.print("*");`
`  }`
`}`
	`Stars(7);`	Java

Activity 8.15

Extend your short program in your chosen programming language to define and use a procedure that accepts a parameter to write a given number of lines of stars. You will find the following commands useful:

- `\n` in Python
- `Writeline` in Visual Basic
- `Println` in Java.

Functions

A function is just like a procedure except it **always** returns a value. Just like a procedure it is defined once and can be called many times within a program. Just like a procedure it can be defined with or without parameters.

Unlike procedures, function calls are not standalone and instead can be made on the right-hand side of an expression.

Instead of naming them functions, different terminology is used by some programming languages. Functions are known as:

- fruitful functions in Python
- functions in VB
- methods with returns in Java.

The keyword **`RETURN`** is used as one of the statements in a function to specify the value to be returned. This is usually the last statement in the function definition.

For example, here is a function written in pseudocode to convert a temperature from Fahrenheit to Celsius:

Parameter and function return both have defined data types.

```
FUNCTION Celsius (Temperature : REAL) RETURNS REAL
    RETURN (Temperature - 32) / 1.8
ENDFUNCTION
```

Because a function returns a value, it can be called by assigning the return value directly into a variable as follows:

```
MyTemp ← Celsius(MyTemp)
```

▼ **Table 8.24** Function definitions

Function temperature conversion example	Language
`def Celsius(Temperature):` `  return (Temperature - 32) / 1.8`	Python – data type of function does not need to be defined

`Function Celsius(ByVal Temperature As Decimal) As Decimal`
`  Return (Temperature - 32) / 1.8`
`End Function`
	Visual Basic

`static double Celsius(double Temperature)`
`{`
`  return (Temperature - 32) / 1.8;`
`}`
	Java

Just like with a procedure, a function call must match the function definition. When a function is defined with parameters, the **arguments** in the function call should match the parameters in the procedure definition. For IGCSE Computer Science the number of parameters used is limited to two.

Activity 8.16

Write an algorithm in pseudocode as a function, with a parameter, to convert a temperature from Celsius to Fahrenheit. Test your algorithm by writing a short program in your chosen programming language to define and use this function.

When procedures and functions are defined, the first statement in the definition is a **header**, which contains:

- the name of the procedure or function
- any parameters passed to the procedure or function, and their data type
- the data type of the return value for a function.

Procedure calls are single standalone statements. Function calls are made as part of an expression, on the right-hand side.

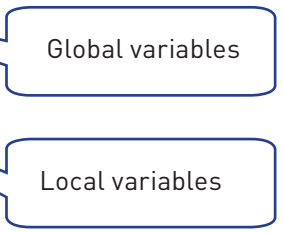
Local and global variables

A **global variable** can be used by any part of a program – its **scope** covers the whole program.

A **local variable** can only be used by the part of the program it has been declared in – its **scope** is restricted to that part of the program.

For example, in this algorithm the variables **`Number1`**, **`Number2`** and **`Answer`** are declared both locally and globally, whereas Number3 is only declared locally.

```
DECLARE Number1, Number2, Answer : INTEGER
PROCEDURE Test
    DECLARE Number3, Answer : INTEGER
    Number1 ← 10
    Number2 ← 20
    Number3 ← 30
    Answer ← Number1 + Number2
    OUTPUT "Number1 is now ", Number1
    OUTPUT "Number2 is now ", Number2
    OUTPUT "Answer is now ", Answer
ENDPROCEDURE
Number1 ← 50
Number2 ← 100
Answer ← Number1 + Number2
OUTPUT "Number1 is ", Number1
OUTPUT "Number2 is ", Number2
OUTPUT "Answer is ", Answer
CALL Test
OUTPUT "Number1 is still ", Number1
OUTPUT "Number2 is still ", Number2
OUTPUT "Answer is still ", Answer
OUTPUT "Number3 is ", Number3
```



The output is

```
Number1 is 50
Number2 is 100
Answer is 150
Number1 is now 10
Number2 is now 20
Answer is now 30
Number1 is still 50
Number2 is still 100
Answer is still 150
ERROR - Number3 is undefined
```

The final line is an error because the main program has tried to access the variable **Number3**, which is local to the procedure.

Activity 8.17

Write and test a short program for the sample algorithm in your chosen programming language.

Activity 8.18

Consider your program for Activity 8.13. State the variables that should be declared and used as local variables if procedures are used for:

- The calculation of the highest, lowest, and average marks awarded for each subject
- The calculation of the highest, lowest, and average marks awarded for each student.

Find out more

As a further challenge rewrite your program for Activity 8.13 using procedures and local and global variables.

Advice

As well as library routines, typical IDEs also contain an editor, for entering code, and an interpreter and/or a compiler, to run the code.

8.1.7 Library routines

Many programming language development systems include **library routines** that are ready to incorporate into a program. These routines are fully tested and ready for use. A programming language IDE usually includes a standard library of functions and procedures. These standard library routines perform many types of task – such as the string handling discussed in Section 8.1.4.

Each programming language has many library routines for standard tasks that are commonly required by programs. Sometimes a set of routines needs to be specifically identified in a program. For example, in Java, the statement `import java.lang.String;` is required at the start of a program to provide access to the string handling library.

You will need to use these library routines in your programs for IGCSE Computer Science:

- **MOD** – returns remainder of a division
- **DIV** – returns the quotient (i.e. the whole number part) of a division
- **ROUND** – returns a value rounded to a given number of decimal places
- **RANDOM** – returns a random number.

Here are some examples of these library routines in pseudocode:

`Value1 ← MOD(10,3)` returns the remainder of `10` divided by `3`

`Value2 ← DIV(10,3)` returns the quotient of `10` divided by `3`

`Value3 ← ROUND(6.97354, 2)` returns the value rounded to `2` decimal places

`Value4 ← RANDOM()` returns a random number between `0` and `1` inclusive

Activity 8.19

Identify the values of the variables `Value1`, `Value2` and `Value3`.

Here are the same examples, written in each programming language:

▼ **Table 8.25** MOD, DIV, ROUND and RANDOM programming examples

Programming examples for MOD, DIV, ROUND and RANDOM	Language

`Value1 = 10%3`
`Value2 = 10//3`
`Value = divmod(10,3)`
`Value3 = round(6.97354, 2)`
`from random import random`
`Value4 = random()`
	Python – MOD uses the `%` operator and DIV the `//` operator
	The function `divmod(x,y)` provides both answers where the first answer is DIV and the second answer is MOD
	RANDOM needs to import the library routine `random`, and then the function: `random()` can be used afterwards

`Value1 = 10 Mod 3`
`Value2 = 10 \ 3`
`Value3 = Math.Round(6.97354, 2)`
`Value4 = Rnd()`
	Visual Basic – DIV uses the `\` operator

`import java.lang.Math;`
`Value1 = 10%3;`
`Value2 = 10/3;`
`Value3 = Math.round(6.97354 * 100)/100.0;`
`import java.util.Random;`
`Random rand = new Random();`
`double Value4 = rand.nextDouble();`
	Java – MOD uses the `%` operator
	DIV uses the normal division operator; if the numbers being divided are both integers then integer division is performed, as shown.
	Java imports the library routine `Math`
	`Math.round` only rounds to whole numbers
	RANDOM needs to import the library routine `Random`

Advice

A program written for a real task should be understandable to another programmer. Program code in a structured questions may not always follow these rules, to test your ability to trace the steps in a routine or correct some errors.

Activity 8.20

Write and test a short program in your chosen programming language to:

- input two integers a and b and then find **a MOD b** and **a DIV b**
- create a random integer between 100 and 300.

8.1.8 Creating a maintainable program

Once a program is written, it may need to be maintained or updated by another programmer at a later date. The programmer may have no documentation other than a copy of the source program. Even a programmer looking at their own program several years later may have forgotten exactly how all the tasks in it were completed!

A maintainable program should:

- always use meaningful identifier names for:
  - variables
  - constants
  - arrays
  - procedures
  - functions